

HongSeok Kim

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Citizenship: Republic of Korea (F1)

Education

Iowa State University

Ph.D. in Economics

Advisor: Professor Juan Carlos Córdoba.

Ames, USA

2021 – 2027 (Expected)

Hanyang University

M.A. in Economics and Finance

B.A. in Economics and Finance

Seoul, Republic of Korea

2021

2019

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Public Economics, Economics of Aging

Job Market Paper

[1] **The Intergenerational Welfare Cost of Social Security Insolvency**

Abstract. This paper asks which generations bear the welfare cost of Social Security insolvency. The trust fund is expected to be depleted in 2033, but each generation meets it at a different age, with different years of benefits at stake and different means of adjusting. In a life-cycle model with endogenous saving, labor supply, human capital, and claiming, I quantify how the expected duration of reduced payments shifts that welfare incidence. The main result is that the cohort losing the most unpaid dollars is not the cohort losing the most welfare. Households that expect the shortfall self-insure by saving, working, and human-capital investment, but the cost of doing so depends on age. The youngest cohorts spread the adjustment over a career, whereas mid-career cohorts must compress it into the years before retirement and end up worse off than if the shortfall had been a surprise. Duration matters as well. When the shortfall is brief, the burden lands mainly on retirees, and when it is prolonged, the burden shifts to the working generations behind them.

Work in Progress

[2] **Generosity, Legibility, and Fertility Inertia**

Abstract. Large family-policy budgets have often produced surprisingly small changes in fertility. The programs that do move births tend to share a different feature: households can tell what they will receive and for how long. I study this distinction in a dynastic fertility model in which parents see public news and policy announcements but are unsure how closely either maps into their own future. A cautious parent evaluates each family plan using the least favorable interpretation she cannot rule out. This behavior creates fertility inertia: moderately adverse news reduces welfare without changing fertility, investment per child, or consumption. It also makes the perceived value of a transfer depend on its worst-case household-level pass-through rather than on the government's expenditure. An opaque program must therefore promise more than a transparent entitlement to generate the same fertility response. The analysis suggests that family policy has two distinct margins, generosity and legibility, and that increasing the first without improving the second can make fertility less responsive to subsequent news.

[1] Optimal Immigration Policy under Private Information

Abstract. This paper studies immigration when applicants privately know the minimum offer needed to migrate and the government uses a common package. Expanding admissions requires raising the package for the marginal applicant and those already willing to enter. The resulting buyerside virtual cost lowers admissions relative to individualized full information but leaves the conditional Golden Rule unchanged. In the baseline example, the immigrant share of the young workforce falls from 19.8 to 11.6 percent. Taxes, entry fees, and bonds implement the allocation. Under aggregate uncertainty, the fee–quota choice depends on whether application pressure signals that desirable admissions have risen.

Fellowships & Awards

Graduate Teaching Excellence Award (Top 10%), Iowa State University	2026
Professional Advancement Grants (PAG), Iowa State University	2026
Graduate Student Workshop Fellowship, Western Economic Association International	2026
Summer Teaching Assistantship, Iowa State University	2025
Most Engaging Presentation Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
Best Discussant Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
Research Travel Grant (\$750) $\times$ 4, Iowa State University	2023–2026
Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020–2021
Academic Scholarship HY-IN Graduate School Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020
Academic Fellowship Korea Student Aid Foundation Fellowship	2019
Graduation Award, Hanyang University	2019

Seminar & Conference

96th Southern Economic Association, Houston [†]	2026
Econometric Society in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, University of Michigan	2026
101th Western Economic Association International	2026
North American Summer Meeting Econometric Society (NASM), Emory University	2026
Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES), Vietnam (Accepted, but cancelled)	2026
Workshop on AI and Machine Learning for Economists, Iowa State University	2025
Southern Economic Association, Washington D.C	2024
19th Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis	2024
Midwest Macro Meetings, Purdue University	2024
Macro Reading Group, Iowa State University	2024
Midwest Economic Association, Chicago	2023

[†]Scheduled.

Academic Experience

Sole Instructor

ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics
(Eval: 4.36/5.0)

Iowa State University
Summer, 2025

Recitation Instructor – Graduate

ECON 6040: Advanced Macroeconomics Analysis
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)

Iowa State University
2024S, 2025S, 2026S

ECON 6020: Macroeconomic Analysis
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)

2025F

ECON 6030: Advanced Microeconomics – Game Theory
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 4.67/5.0)

2023S

ECON 5710: Intermediate Econometrics
(Masters, Eval: 4.5/5.0)

2026S

Teaching Assistant/Lab Instructor – Undergraduate

Iowa State University

ECON 3020: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Eval: 5.0/5.0)

2025

ECON 3710: Introduction to Econometrics (Eval: 4.29/5.0)

2021

ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics

2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics

2021, 2023, 2024

Academic Service

Discussions

“Urbanicity and Fertility: Evidence from Refugees to Canada”,
– Midwest Economics Association Meetings, Chicago

2024

Guest Lecture

ECON3270 (Economics of Discrimination)

– Quantity-Quality Trade-off of Gary Becker’s Model

2025

Other Service

Economic Help Room Services for the Undergraduates

2021, 2023

References

Juan Carlos Córdoba

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